

The APC Confidence Checklist

What strong candidates do differently before assessment day.

This checklist was created to help you assess how prepared you really are before assessment day — not in knowledge, but in confidence, clarity and performance under pressure. Work through it honestly. The gaps you find are more valuable than the ticks.

HOW TO SCORE

✓ Yes — genuinely done this, confident it is true

■ Partly — done it, but not enough times to trust it under pressure

■ Not yet — have not done this — worth addressing before assessment day

SECTION 1 OF 5

Understanding & Clarity

I can explain each of my competencies clearly without relying on memorised wording.

✓ Yes

■ Partly

■ Not yet

I understand why my experience demonstrates competency — not just what I did.

✓ Yes

■ Partly

■ Not yet

I could explain my case study decisions confidently to someone who was not involved.

✓ Yes

■ Partly

■ Not yet

SECTION 2 OF 5

Interview Readiness

I have practised answering competency questions out loud, not just in my head.

Reading is not practising. Your mouth needs the repetitions, not your brain.

✓ Yes

■ Partly

■ Not yet

I can speak clearly about difficult projects or decisions without rambling.

✓ Yes

■ Partly

■ Not yet

I have practised handling follow-up questions calmly when challenged.

✓ Yes

■ Partly

■ Not yet

SECTION 3 OF 5

Confidence & Communication

I know what assessors are actually listening for — not just what the RICS guidance says.

✓ Yes

■ Partly

■ Not yet

I can structure answers clearly under pressure without losing my thread.

✓ Yes

■ Partly

■ Not yet

I speak professionally and concisely when I practise — not only when I write things down.

✓ Yes

■ Partly

■ Not yet

SECTION 4 OF 5

Revision Quality

I am actively rehearsing answers — not just rereading notes and hoping it sticks.

✓ Yes

■ Partly

■ Not yet

I have identified my weakest competency area and done something specific about it.

✓ Yes

■ Partly

■ Not yet

I can recall real examples from memory without freezing when asked directly.

✓ Yes

■ Partly

■ Not yet

SECTION 5 OF 5

Mental Preparation

I have prepared for nerves as well as knowledge.

Nerves are not a knowledge problem. They require a separate type of preparation.

✓ Yes

■ Partly

■ Not yet

I know how I will reset if I lose confidence mid-interview.

✓ Yes

■ Partly

■ Not yet

I understand that confidence comes from repetition — not from knowing more.

✓ Yes

■ Partly

■ Not yet

WHAT TO DO WITH YOUR RESULTS

Three or more "Not yet" responses in any section is worth acting on.

This checklist is not designed to tell you how much you know. It is designed to show you where your preparation has gaps — specifically in performance, articulation and confidence under pressure. Those gaps do not close by reading more. They close by practising the right things, repeatedly, before assessment day.

The Get Chartered AI APC Sprint is designed exactly for this — pathway-specific mock interviews, AI-supported revision and repeated practice before assessment day.

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